Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A112A
Cultures I

Main - All Branches
Final Exam

2024-2025/Fall Semester
Date: 13 Jan. 2025
4:30 – 7:30

Number of Exam Pages: 4 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 3 Hours

INSTRUCTIONS

This exam consists of TWO PARTS.

PART 1 contains 3 SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer t in PARAGRAPH FORMAT.

PART 2 contains 3 ESSAY QUESTIONS. You must choose TWO and answer them in ESS FORMAT.

Write the question number next to each answer.

Do not answer more questions than required.

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Part 1: Short Answer Questions

(10 points = 5 points for each answer)

Please choose TWO of the following questions and respond to them in paragraph format. Each answer should be approximately 80 words long, addressing all relevant aspects of the question with appropriate evidence from the course material. Ensure that each paragraph includes a clear topic sentence, supporting details, and a conclusion.

1. Who was **Apollo** in ancient Greek mythology, and what were his major roles or attributes?
2. What distinguishes a **'portrait medal'** from other forms of portraiture in visual arts, such as paintings or sculptures?
3. What is **'satire'**? How is it used by Otto Dix against war?

Part 2: Essay Questions

(40 points= 20 points for each essay)

Please choose TWO of the essay prompts below and write comprehensive responses in essay format. Your essays should be around 350 words each, covering all relevant aspects of the questions and backed by evidence from the course material. Make sure to structure your essays with an introduction, multiple body paragraphs, and a conclusion.

4. What role did **votive offerings** have in ancient Greek religious practices? Discuss the history, function, and significance of three votive offerings at the temple of Delphi: **the Naxian sphinx, the Charioteer of Delphi**, and **the Plataean Serpent Column**.
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. What are votive offerings, and why were they important in ancient Greek religion?
   b. What is the history and significance of the Naxian sphinx as a votive offering at Delphi?
   c. How did the Charioteer of Delphi serve as a votive offering, and what does it reveal about the values of ancient Greek society?
   d. What does the Plataean Serpent Column represent, and how does it reflect the relationships between different Greek city-states?

5. In a well-structured essay, analyze Titian's portrait of ***Eleonora Gonzaga, Duchess of Urbino***, considering its genre, subject matter, visual/formal elements, historical context, iconography/symbolism, and function. In your essay, consider how Titian's portrait of ***Eleonora Gonzaga*** reflects both the individual characteristics of the sitter and the broader cultural and social milieu of Renaissance Italy.
   Your answer must address the following questions:
   a. What is the genre of Titian's portrait of ***Eleonora Gonzaga***?
   b. How does the historical context of Eleonora Gonzaga's life inform our understanding of the portrait?

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c. What are the iconographic elements present in the portrait and what is their symbolic significance?
d. How do these symbols contribute to the portrayal of Eleonora Gonzaga's identity and status?
e. How do the visual elements (such as composition, color, light, shade, style, etc.) enhance the portrait's depiction of Eleonora Gonzaga?
f. Discuss the potential function of the portrait within the context of Renaissance court culture.
g. What role did portraits of noblewomen like Eleonora Gonzaga serve in Renaissance society?



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6. In a well-structured essay, analyze Goya's painting, ***The Third of May 1808***, considering its genre, subject matter, visual/formal elements, historical context, iconography/symbolism, and function. Explore the messages conveyed by this artwork about the human experience during conflict.

Your answer must address the following questions:

a. What genre does Goya's painting ***The Third of May 1808*** belong to, and what are the key characteristics of this genre?
b. What is the main subject matter of the painting, and what historical event does it depict?
c. What visual elements, such as color, light, and composition, are used in the painting, and how do they affect the viewer's emotions?
d. What historical context is important to understand about the events surrounding the painting's creation?
e. What symbols and iconography are present in the artwork, and what deeper meanings do they convey about conflict and suffering?
f. What messages about the human experience during times of conflict can be drawn from this painting, and how do they relate to the broader themes of war and humanity?



End of the Exam!

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